AI-Powered Listening: Turning Text into Audio with Audioread

How-to Guide

The Tool

Audioread is an AI-powered text-to-speech platform designed to turn written content into natural-sounding audio for listening on the go. It allows users to convert articles, PDFs, emails, plain text, and RSS feeds into audio that can be streamed in a browser or through a private podcast feed in podcast apps such as Apple Podcasts, Spotify, and other podcast players.

The tool is built for long-form listening and supports workflows across desktop and mobile devices. Users can submit content through a browser extension, web app, mobile shortcuts, drag-and-drop uploads, email forwarding, or RSS feeds. Pro platform subscriptions also support more than 80 languages, MP3 downloads, browser-based playback, adjustable listening speed, and privacy features such as auto-deletion after 30 days.

One of Audioread's most distinctive features is that it does not simply read content aloud in a basic robotic voice. Instead, it is designed to produce more natural, human-like narration for longer content such as research articles, reports, newsletters, and professional reading materials. This makes it useful for learners and professionals who want to absorb information while commuting, walking, exercising, or doing routine tasks away from a screen.

What You'll Learn

This guide explains how to use Audioread to convert written material into audio and build a simple listen-first workflow for reading on the go. You will learn how to input content in different ways, generate AI narration, and choose how to listen through your browser, podcast app, or downloaded audio file.

By the end of this activity, you will understand how to turn articles, documents, and emails into audio using Audioread's text-to-speech workflow. You will also learn how to review outputs carefully, choose the right type of content for listening, and think critically about privacy, accessibility, and accuracy when using AI-generated audio in personal, educational, or workplace settings.

Steps: Turning Text into Audio

This step-by-step walkthrough shows how to take written content such as an article, PDF, or email, and convert it into audio that can be streamed or downloaded for flexible listening.

1. Choose Your Content

In this example, a piece of written content, a research article, is selected that would normally be read on screen. Online article links, PDFs, or emails can be converted to audio.

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Catalyzing next-generation Artificial Intelligence through NeuroAI

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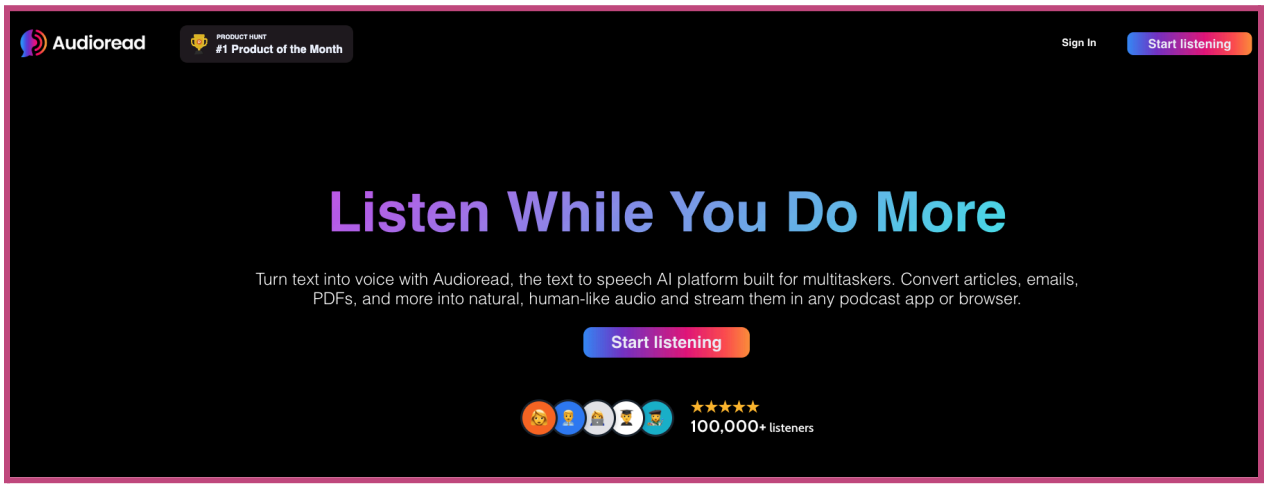
Neuroscience has long been an essential driver of progress in artificial intelligence (AI). We propose that to accelerate progress in AI, we must invest in fundamental research in NeuroAI. A core component of this is the embodied Turing test, which challenges AI animal models to interact with the sensorimotor world at skill levels akin to their living counterparts. The embodied Turing test shifts the focus from those capabilities like game playing and language that are especially well-developed or uniquely human to those capabilities – inherited from over 500 million years of evolution – that are shared with all animals. Building models that can pass the embodied Turing test will provide a roadmap for the next generation of AI.

Over the coming decades, Artificial Intelligence (AI) will transform society and the world economy in ways that are as profound as the computer revolution of the last half century and likely at an even faster pace. This AI revolution presents tremendous opportunities to unleash human creativity and catalyze economic growth, relieving workers from performing the most dangerous and menial jobs. However, to reach this potential, we still require advances that will make AI more human-like in its capabilities. Historically, neuroscience has been a critical driver and source of inspiration for improvements in AI, particularly those that made AI more proficient in areas that humans and other animals excel at, such as vision, reward-based learning, interacting with the physical world, and language[1,2]. It can still play this role. To accelerate progress in AI and realize its vast potential, we must invest in fundamental research in "NeuroAI."

To prepare your own content:

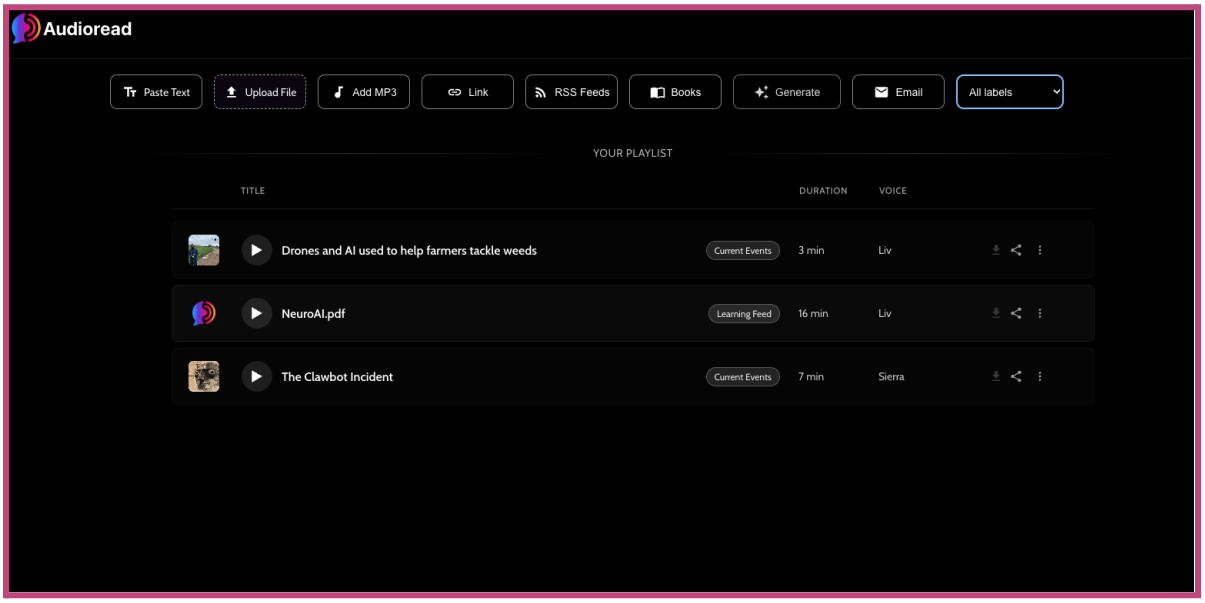
- ☐ Choose one piece of content you would like to listen to instead of read
- ☐ Start with something clear and text-based, such as a news article, blog post, newsletter, or PDF
- ☐ Make sure the content is complete and readable before uploading or pasting it
- ☐ Avoid scanned documents or poorly formatted text if possible, since these may reduce audio quality
- ☐ Do not use confidential, personal, or sensitive information unless you are certain the tool is approved for that use

2. Open Audioread



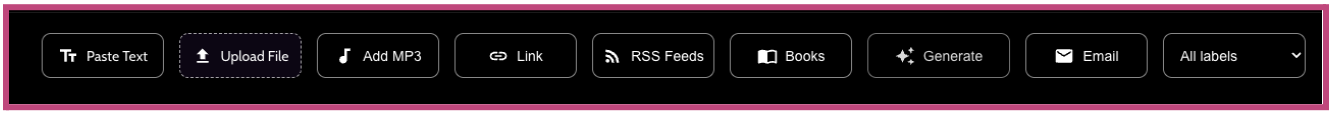
Go to Audioread and create a free account. While the free version includes limits on the number of characters per conversion, the number of articles you can convert each month, and the available voice and language options, it provides a good starting point for exploring the platform.

3. Navigate Your Playlist Page



The playlist page includes an action bar that lets you add content in several ways. You can paste text, upload files, add MP3 audio, insert web links, subscribe to RSS feeds (which integrate podcast-style content into the platform), or use the email feature. The email option generates a unique address that you can send messages or content to, allowing them to appear automatically in your playlist for listening.

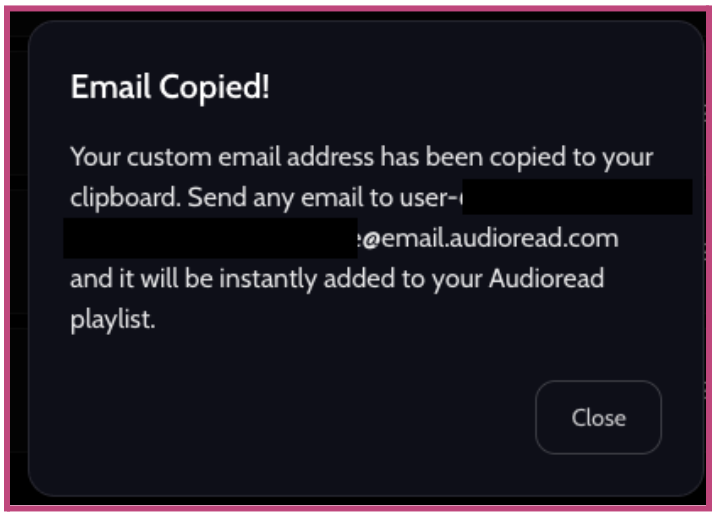
Note: Books and Generate functions are Pro features.



Audioread action bar

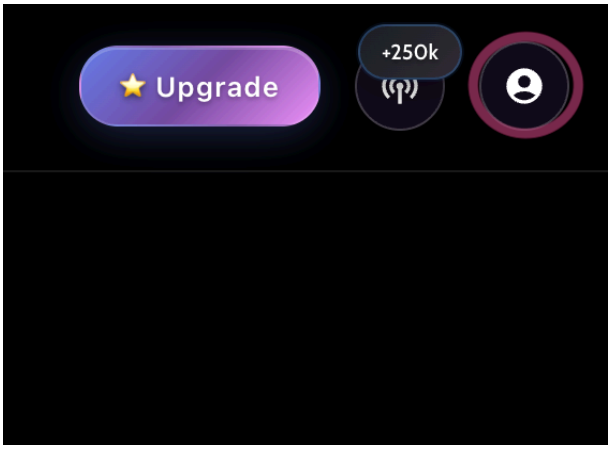
Start experimenting by:

- ☐ Uploading a PDF to your playlist
- ☐ Pasting an article link for your playlist
- ☐ Selecting the Email action and sending a message to the unique email address associated with your Audioread account.

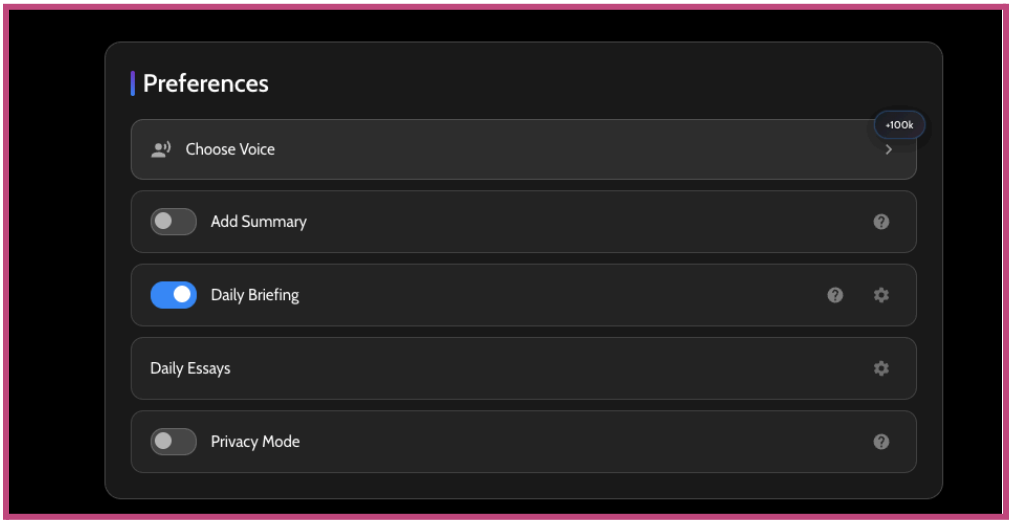


Your unique email address is generated when you select the Email action and is automatically copied to your clipboard.

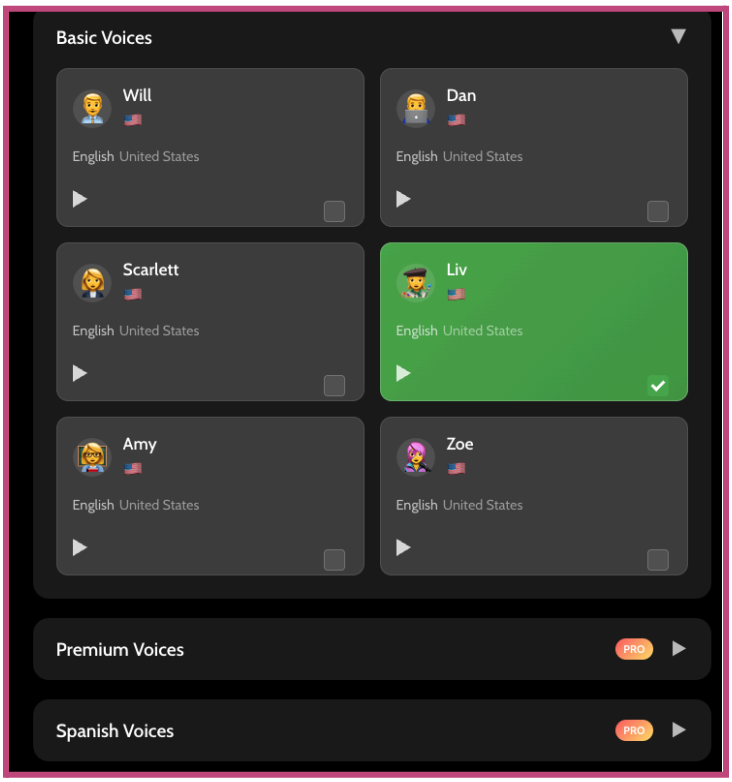
4. Choose an AI generated voice



- [ ] Select the profile icon



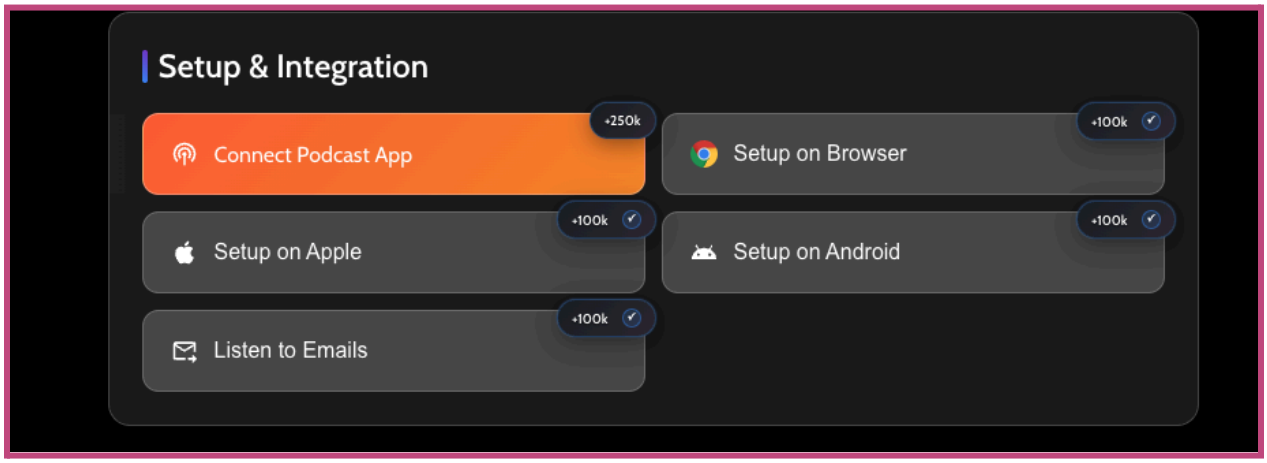
In the preference settings, you can choose available voice options with the free plan. When Privacy Mode is enabled, articles you convert to audio remain private and are automatically deleted from Audioread after 30 days. Sharing options are disabled, and the content is excluded from search engines so it cannot be indexed or discovered publicly. Note: Privacy mode can only be enabled within Pro plans.



Audioread voice options with the free plan

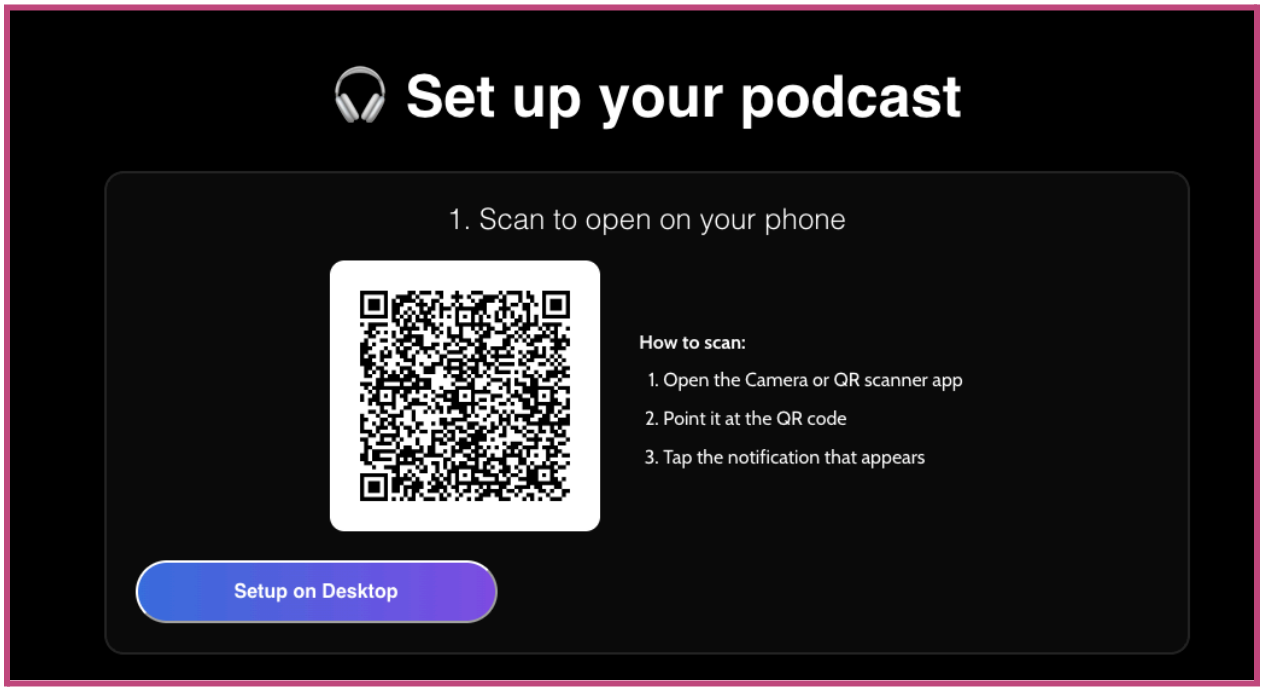
5. Set up and Integration

This step includes ways in which you can connect your audioread playlist with other music/podcast listening platforms and apps. This is also included within the preferences page.



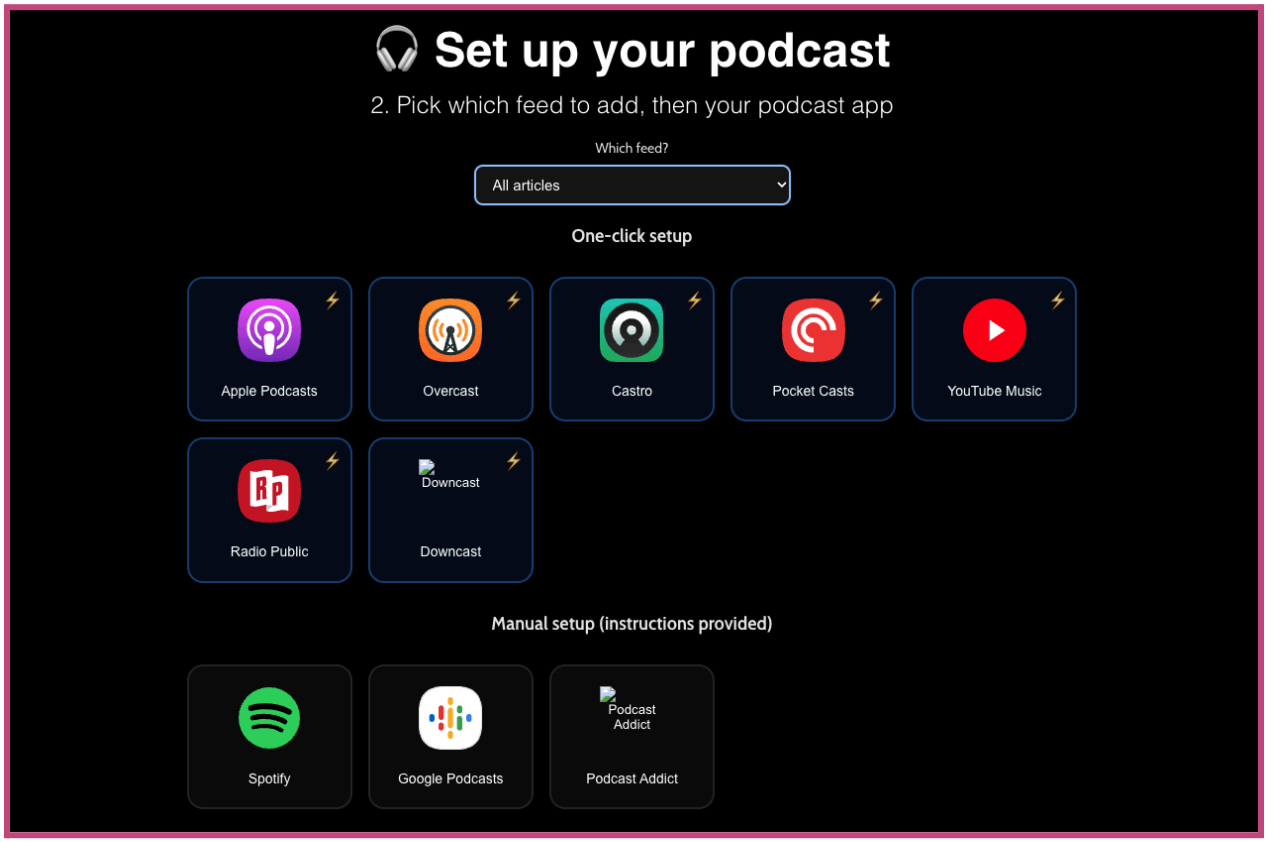
There are multiple ways to set up and integrate your playlist so audio can be streamed in different ways. This example demonstrates how to connect a podcast app.

- [ ] Select connect podcast app



For this example, the podcast will be set up on the desktop. Scan the QR code for setting up on a mobile device.

- [ ] Select setup on desktop



Once you link a podcast app with audioread, when you add more content into the audioread platform, it will automatically appear within your listening app. For example, content added on "my playlist page" will appear in a youtube music library.

- [ ] Select the application you want to link with your audioread account
- [ ] Start creating a personal playlist of listening content
- [ ] Download audio you want to read offline through your listening app of choice

6. Build a Repeatable Workflow

Once the first conversion works, try building Audioread into your regular routine.

- [ ] Use the browser extension for articles you discover online (only available with Pro)

- [ ] Save reports or PDFs to convert during the workday
- [ ] Forward newsletters or long emails you want to catch up on later
- [ ] Use podcast playback to turn reading lists into listening queues
- [ ] Keep track of which types of documents work best in audio form

7. Check and Reflect

This is a crucial step to verify that the audio output is accurate, usable, and appropriate for your purpose. Although Audioread is designed to create clear, human-like narration, users should still review the result to ensure the content was captured and read correctly.

- [ ] Confirm the correct article, PDF, or text was imported
- [ ] Listen to the beginning of the audio to check pronunciation, pacing, and flow
- [ ] Compare the title and opening lines against the original source
- [ ] Check whether important headings, numbers, names, or technical terms are read correctly
- [ ] Ask yourself: "Would listening help me understand this content, or is this better suited for visual reading?"
- [ ] Consider whether the content includes tables, code, charts, or formatting that may not translate well into audio

When in Doubt

- [ ] Re-submit the content using a cleaner format, such as plain text instead of a cluttered webpage
- [ ] Break a long or complex document into smaller sections
- [ ] Keep the original text open so you can compare sections as you listen
- [ ] Use the summary first to preview whether the content has been captured accurately (Only available with PRO)
- [ ] Choose a different type of content if the material relies heavily on visuals, formulas, or layout

Common Pitfalls

While Audioread can make written content easier to consume on the move, learners should be mindful of a few important limitations and responsibilities.

Privacy and content sensitivity: Audioread may be convenient for emails, reports, or PDFs, but users should think carefully before uploading personal, confidential, or proprietary material. Even with privacy features such as auto-deletion, organizations and individuals should confirm whether a tool is approved before using it with internal or sensitive information.

Audio is not always the best format: Some types of content translate well into narration, while others do not. Articles, essays, newsletters, and reports often work well, but content that depends on charts, tables, code blocks, equations, or complex formatting may become harder to understand in audio form.

Misheard details or awkward narration: AI-generated speech may occasionally mispronounce names, abbreviations, technical terms, or numbers. Users should not assume that a natural-sounding voice guarantees perfect accuracy. Important details should still be cross-checked against the original text.

In Action

Below are examples of how different teams or learners could use Audioread in everyday scenarios.

Important: Do not upload sensitive, confidential, or proprietary information unless the tool has been approved for that context. If you are unsure, use public, low-risk, or sample content while learning.

TIP: Start with one article or short document. Once you understand the workflow, you can build Audioread into a broader reading, study, or productivity routine.

Audioread in Action		
Groups	**Scenario in Action**	**Audioread Use Example**
Students & Researchers	Convert assigned readings into audio for review while commuting or doing routine tasks.	Upload a reading or paste a link to an online article, then listen through the browser or podcast app while reviewing key ideas.
Marketing & Communications	Turn newsletters, trend reports, or long-form articles into audio for faster content review.	Paste a webpage or upload a report so team members can listen to industry updates away from their desks.
Business Professionals	Catch up on articles, reports, or email-based updates during travel or between meetings.	Forward a newsletter or upload a PDF briefing to create an audio version for listening on the move.
Accessibility & Learning Support	Offer an alternative format for people who prefer listening over screen-based reading.	Convert text-heavy materials into audio so users can engage with content in a more flexible way.
Knowledge Workers	Build a repeatable workflow for consuming saved reading lists more efficiently.	Use the browser extension or RSS feed to turn saved content into a personalized listening queue.

References

Audioread. (2026). *Audioread*. https://audioread.com

Audioread. (2026). *How text-to-speech works with Audioread*. https://audioread.com/how-it-works

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